

COMPUTING PREMIER LEAGUE

OFFICIAL TOURNAMENT RULES & COMPETITION HANDBOOK · 2026

Date: Sunday, Sept 13, 2026
Venue: Ratmalana CGR Ground
Format: 9 Teams · 16 Matches
Authority: CPL Executive Committee

1. TOURNAMENT OVERVIEW

The **Computing Premier League (CPL) 2026** is the premier inter-intake softball cricket championship. The entire tournament is governed and monitored in real time using the official CPL digital scoring platform, featuring live ball-by-ball scoring, mathematical softball Net Run Rate (NRR) calculations, and automated bracket progression.

- **Official Venue:** Ratmalana CGR Ground (Ratmalana United S.C)
- **Date & Reporting Time:** Sunday, September 13, 2026 · Captains report by 7:45 AM (First ball: 8:00 AM)
- **Participating Teams:** Exactly 9 registered departmental squads
- **Competition Format:** 4 Stages (Group Stage, Wildcard Stage, Final Four Playoffs, Grand Final)
- **Total Matches:** Exactly 16 matches

2. TOURNAMENT STRUCTURE

The tournament format guarantees competitive balance while providing multiple paths to the championship:

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STAGE 1: GROUP STAGE (9 Teams · 3 Groups of 3 · 9 Matches) | Group A Winner | Group B Winner | DIRECT QUALIFICATION TO FINAL FOUR (Seeds #1, #2, #3) | Group C Winner |
| Group A Runner-Up | Group B Runner-Up | STAGE 2: WILDCARD STAGE (3 Teams · 3 Matches) | Group C Runner-Up | Wildcard Winner | QUALIFIED AS SEED #4 | 2nd & 3rd Place — ELIMINATED | 3rd Place Teams in Groups A, B, C — ELIMINATED
STAGE 3: FINAL FOUR PLAYOFFS (4 Teams · Modified Double Elimination · 3 Matches) | Qualifier 1: Seed #1 vs Seed #2 — Winner |
| Loser (Second Chance) | Eliminator: Seed #3 vs Seed #4 | STAGE 4: GRAND FINAL (M16) |
| Winner | Q2 | CHAMPION CROWNED! | Loser — ELIMINATED
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3. GROUP STAGE

The 9 registered teams are assigned into three groups of three: **Group A**, **Group B**, and **Group C**.

- **Format:** Single round-robin within each group. Every team plays the other two teams in its group once.
- **Matches per Team:** Exactly 2 matches per team in the group stage.
- **Total Group Matches:** 9 matches total (Matches 1 through 9).
- **Progression Rules:**
 - **1ST PLACE (GROUP WINNER)**: Advances directly to the **Final Four Playoffs**.
 - **2ND PLACE (GROUP RUNNER-UP)**: Advances to the **Wildcard Stage** for a second chance.
 - **3RD PLACE (BOTTOM TEAM)**: Officially **ELIMINATED** from the tournament.

GROUP	MATCH NUMBER	PAIRING	ALLOTTED OVERS	PROGRESSION STAKES
Group A	Match 1, 2, 3	A1 vs A2, A2 vs A3, A1 vs A3	4 Overs / 4 Balls	1st → Final Four · 2nd → Wildcard · 3rd → Out
Group B	Match 4, 5, 6	B1 vs B2, B2 vs B3, B1 vs B3	4 Overs / 4 Balls	1st → Final Four · 2nd → Wildcard · 3rd → Out
Group C	Match 7, 8, 9	C1 vs C2, C2 vs C3, C1 vs C3	4 Overs / 4 Balls	1st → Final Four · 2nd → Wildcard · 3rd → Out

4. WILDCARD STAGE (RUNNER-UP STAGE)

The Wildcard Stage provides the three second-place teams a second pathway into the championship bracket:

- **Participants:** Exactly 3 teams — Runner-Up Group A, Runner-Up Group B, Runner-Up Group C.
- **Format:** Single round-robin (3 matches total):
 - **Match 10:** Runner-Up Group A vs Runner-Up Group B
 - **Match 11:** Runner-Up Group B vs Runner-Up Group C
 - **Match 12:** Runner-Up Group A vs Runner-Up Group C
- **Clean-Slate Stage:** The Wildcard Stage maintains its **own standalone standings table**. Points and Net Run Rates from the Group Stage do **NOT** carry over. All three teams start at 0 points and 0.00 NRR.
- **Qualification:**
 - The team finishing **1st in the Wildcard table** qualifies for the Final Four as **Seed #4**.
 - The 2nd and 3rd placed teams in the Wildcard table are **ELIMINATED**.

5. FINAL FOUR & PLAYOFFS

The top 4 teams compete in a modified Page-playoff system:

Seeding Determination

- **Seeds #1, #2, and #3:** Awarded to the 3 Group Winners. Group winners are ranked against each other based purely on their Group Stage records:
 1. Points earned in Group Stage (max 4)
 2. Net Run Rate (NRR) in Group Stage
 3. Total runs scored in Group Stage
 4. Alphabetical / administrative tie-breaker

Best Group Winner = **Seed #1** · 2nd Best = **Seed #2** · 3rd Best = **Seed #3**.

- **Seed #4:** Awarded strictly to the **Wildcard Stage Winner**.

Playoff Fixtures & Double-Elimination Protection

MATCH	STAGE NAME	MATCHUP	WINNER ADVANCES TO	LOSER STATUS
Match 13	Qualifier 1	Seed #1 vs Seed #2	Grand Final (Match 16)	Advances to Qualifier 2 (Second Chance)
Match 14	Eliminator	Seed #3 vs Seed #4 [Wildcard]	Advances to Qualifier 2	ELIMINATED
Match 15	Qualifier 2	Loser Q1 vs Winner Eliminator	Grand Final (Match 16)	ELIMINATED

6. GRAND FINAL

- **Match 16:** Winner of Qualifier 1 vs Winner of Qualifier 2
- **Championship Crown:** The winner of Match 16 is officially crowned the **CPL 2026 Champion**.
- **Runner-Up:** The loser of Match 16 takes 2nd place as the **Tournament Runner-Up**.

7. MATCH FORMAT

Each match stores its own configuration directly in the database. The tournament rules use the following stage limits:

STAGE	OVERS / INNINGS	BALLS / OVER	TOTAL LEGAL BALLS / INNINGS	MAX LEGAL BALLS / MATCH
Stage 1: Group Stage (M1–M9)	4 Overs	4 Balls	16 Balls	32 Balls
Stage 2: Wildcard Stage (M10–M12)	5 Overs	4 Balls	20 Balls	40 Balls
Stage 3: Playoffs (M13–M15)	6 Overs	4 Balls	24 Balls	48 Balls
Stage 4: Grand Final (M16)	6 Overs	4 Balls	24 Balls	48 Balls

Format Lockdown Rule: Format parameters (balls per over and stage overs) are chosen by the committee before fixtures are created. Once fixtures are generated, format rules are **LOCKED** to ensure historical NRR consistency across all scorecards.

8. SOFTBALL BALLS & OVERS NOTATION

In CPL softball cricket, **cricket display notation** is strictly separated from **mathematical Net Run Rate overs**:

- **Cricket Scoreboard Notation (Display Only):** Written as CompletedOvers.RemainingBalls.
In a 4-ball over match: 0.1 = 1 ball · 0.2 = 2 balls · 0.3 = 3 balls · 1.0 = 4 balls · 1.1 = 5 balls · 1.2 = 6 balls · 1.3 = 7 balls · 2.0 = 8 balls.
- **Mathematical Effective Overs (Used for NRR Mathematics):** $\text{Effective Overs} = \frac{\text{Legal Balls Bowled}}{\text{Balls Per Over}}$ With 4 balls per over: 5 legal balls = $5 / 4 = \mathbf{1.25}$ overs (**NEVER 1.1** in mathematical formulas).
- **Extras:** Wides and No-Balls do **not** count as legal deliveries and must be re-bowled. Byes and Leg-Byes count as legal deliveries.
- **Free Hit Rule:** Any No-Ball triggers an automatic **Free Hit** on the subsequent delivery. The batter cannot be dismissed bowled, caught, LBW, or stumped on a Free Hit (Run Out remains active).

9. NET RUN RATE (NRR) ENGINE

Authoritative NRR Formula:

$$\text{NRR} = \left(\frac{\text{Total Runs Scored}}{\text{Total Effective Overs Faced}} \right) - \left(\frac{\text{Total Runs Conceded}}{\text{Total Effective Overs Bowled}} \right)$$

1. The Mandatory All-Out Rule

If a team is dismissed all-out before completing its allotted overs:

- Their NRR denominator is credited as their **full allotted innings overs** for that match.
- *Example:* In a 4-over group match, if Team A is bowled all-out in 13 legal balls (3.1 overs) scoring 30 runs:
 - Team A's overs faced = **4.00 overs** (NOT 3.25 overs).
 - Team A's run rate = $30 / 4.00 = \mathbf{7.50}$ runs/over (NOT $30 / 3.25 = 9.23$).
 - Team B (fielding team) is credited with their actual bowling effort: 13 legal balls = **3.25 overs bowled**.

2. Early Target Chase Rule

If a team batting second successfully chases down the target in fewer overs:

- Their actual legal deliveries are used. Winning chasing teams are **never** penalized with full allotted overs.
- *Example:* Chasing 31 runs, Team B reaches 32/2 in 2.2 overs (10 legal balls = 2.50 effective overs). Their batting overs faced = **2.50 overs** (Run Rate = 12.80).

3. Super Over Isolation

Deliveries, runs, and wickets in Super Overs (Innings 3 & 4) are strictly **excluded** from NRR calculations. Only regular completed innings (Innings 1 & 2) count toward tournament tables.

10. OFFICIAL POINTS SYSTEM

MATCH RESULT	POINTS AWARDED	NRR IMPACT
WIN	2 Points	Full runs scored and conceded credited to team totals
TIE (Scores Level, No Super Over)	1 Point	Full runs scored and conceded credited equally
NO RESULT (Abandoned / Rain Washout)	1 Point	Incomplete match excluded from NRR calculations
LOSS	0 Points	Full runs scored and conceded credited to team totals

11. TIE-BREAKING HIERARCHY

When two or more teams finish level on points in a standings table, positions are determined in this exact order:

1. **Points:** Higher points ranks higher.
2. **Net Run Rate (NRR):** Higher Net Run Rate (evaluated to unrounded floating-point precision) ranks higher.
3. **Head-to-Head (H2H):**
 - **2-Team Tie:** The team that won the head-to-head match between the two tied teams ranks higher.
 - **3-Team Tie:** A mini-league head-to-head table is computed taking only matches between the three tied teams. If one team won both matches, they rank first.
4. **Total Runs Scored:** Highest aggregate runs scored across the stage.
5. **Total Wickets Taken:** Highest aggregate bowling dismissals across the stage.
6. **Alphabetical / Committee Fallback:** Deterministic alphabetical order pending tournament committee review.

12. TIED MATCHES & SUPER OVERS

- **Regular Play Tie:** If scores are equal at the end of both innings, the match is officially recorded as a **TIE** (1 point each in group/wildcard play).
- **Super Over Procedure:** In knockout rounds (Playoffs & Grand Final) or upon committee activation:
 - Consists of **1 over per team** (at the match's configured balls-per-over).
 - Maximum **2 wickets** allowed per innings in the Super Over.
 - The team batting second in the main match bats first in the Super Over.
 - The winner of the Super Over is awarded the match victory.

13. LIVE DIGITAL SCORING RULES

- **Scoring Console:** All matches are scored live by official CPL scorers using the digital console.
- **Lineup Selection:** Before the first delivery of each innings, captains must confirm the opening Striker, Non-Striker, and Bowler with the scorer.
- **Dismissal Types:** Bowled, Caught, LBW, Run Out, Stumped, Hit Wicket, Timed Out, Retired Hurt.
- **Second Innings Target:** The target is automatically calculated as $\text{Innings 1 Total Score} + 1$.
- **Automatic Match Conclusion:** The platform automatically ends the match the instant the chasing team surpasses the target or when the fielding team captures the final wicket / bowls the final delivery.

14. SQUAD & ELIGIBILITY RULES

- **Squad Size:** Minimum **7 players**, maximum **13 players** per squad.
- **Playing Captain:** The team leader registered on the entry form must be a playing squad member.
- **Intake Uniformity Rule:** All squad members must belong to the **same university intake batch**. Mixed-intake squads are strictly disallowed by the system.
- **Student Verification:** All participants must be active university students with verified student index numbers.

15. PUBLIC TOURNAMENT HUB FEATURES

Captains, players, and supporters have real-time access via /tournament on any mobile device:

- **Bracket Tab:** Visual roadmap of Group Stages, Wildcard Stage, Final Four, and Grand Final.
- **Standings Tab:** Live group standings with Wins, Losses, Points, Mathematical Overs, and NRR.
- **Fixtures Tab:** Schedule, pitch allocations, match start times, and live scorecard links.
- **Digital Scorecard:** Ball-by-ball commentary, strike rates, economy rates, and fall of wickets.

16. MATCH COUNT BREAKDOWN

TOURNAMENT STAGE	MATCH IDENTIFIERS	NUMBER OF MATCHES
Stage 1: Group Stage	Matches 1 through 9	9 Matches
Stage 2: Wildcard Stage	Matches 10 through 12	3 Matches
Stage 3: Final Four Playoffs	Matches 13 (Q1), 14 (Elim), 15 (Q2)	3 Matches
Stage 4: Grand Final	Match 16 (CPL Championship)	1 Match
TOTAL TOURNAMENT MATCHES		16 Matches

17. FREQUENTLY ASKED QUESTIONS (CAPTAIN FAQ)

Q1: How many teams qualify from each group?

A: Exactly 1 team qualifies directly to the Final Four. The 2nd-place team moves to the Wildcard Stage. The 3rd-place team is eliminated.

Q2: Does Group Stage NRR carry over into the Wildcard Stage?

A: No. The Wildcard Stage has an independent standings table. All three wildcard teams start at 0 points and 0.00 NRR.

Q3: How is Seed #1 determined?

A: The 3 group winners are ranked against each other based purely on their Group Stage records (Points → NRR → Total Runs → Alphabetical). The best group winner gets Seed #1.

Q4: If we are bowled all-out early, what overs count for our NRR?

A: If bowled all-out before your allotted overs, your NRR denominator is credited as your **full allotted overs** (e.g. 4.0 overs in Group Stage, 6.0 in Finals).

Q5: If we chase the target in 2.2 overs, do we get penalized with 4 overs?

A: No. Winning chasing teams are credited with their actual legal balls faced (e.g. 10 balls / 4 = 2.50 overs). The all-out rule is never applied to a successful chase.

Q6: In a 4-ball over, is 5 balls written as 1.25 on the scorecard?

A: On the digital scoreboard, it is displayed as 1.1 (1 over and 1 ball). In NRR formulas, it is calculated as $5 / 4 = 1.25$ overs.

Q7: Does a Wide or No-Ball count as a legal ball?

A: No. A Wide or No-Ball adds 1 penalty run, but does not advance the ball count. The delivery must be re-bowled.

Q8: What happens if our team loses Qualifier 1?

A: You are not eliminated. You advance to Qualifier 2 to play the winner of the Eliminator for a spot in the Grand Final.

Q9: What happens if our team loses the Eliminator?

A: You are eliminated from the tournament immediately.

Q10: What is the maximum number of matches our team can play?

A: A team reaching the Grand Final via the Wildcard route plays up to **6 matches** (2 group + 2 wildcard + Eliminator + Qualifier 2 + Grand Final). Direct group qualifiers play 4 matches.

18. RULES REQUIRING COMMITTEE CONFIRMATION

The following operational items exist in standard cricket but are managed on the ground rather than automated in code.

Captains must confirm these at the morning briefing:

1. **Maximum Overs per Bowler:** Confirmation of bowler limits (e.g., maximum 1 over per bowler in 4-over matches).
2. **Match-Day Toss Cutoff:** Reporting deadline for captains at the centre turf (typically 15 minutes before scheduled start).
3. **Fielding Restrictions:** Inner-circle fielder limits during powerplay overs.
4. **Ball Type:** Exact ball weight and specifications provided by the organizing committee.

Computing Premier League 2026 · Official Tournament Rulebook · Generated directly from the authoritative CPL digital scoring engine.